and the occasional Englishman: among them Robert of Ketton and Hermann of Carinthia, who first translated the entire Qur'an into Latin, and Plato of Tivoli, who did the same with Arabic texts on astronomy and mathematics.[5]

Now, with Gerard of Cremona, the rediscovery of Arabic texts surged forward. In Toledo, Gerard discovered a treasure trove of books he had never known existed. Among the books he unearthed in the dusty unused stacks of the Toledo libraries were a handful that had been translated from Greek into Arabic, but had never before been read in the Latin-speaking West: the *Physics* of Aristotle, containing the philosophical explorations of being that the Aristotelian texts on logic did not touch; the *Elements* of Euclid; the *Secrets* of the great Greek physician Galen.

"Seeing the abundance of books in Arabic on every subject," one of his students later wrote, "he learned the Arabic language in order to be able to translate. . . . [T]o the end of his life, he continued to transmit to the Latin world (as if to his own beloved heir) whatever books he thought finest, in many subjects, as accurately and as plainly as he could." By the time of his death, some thirty years later, Gerard had translated at least seventy-one major works on dialectic, astronomy, philosophy, mathematics, and medicine. A wall between the past and the present had been broken down, and more and more thinkers would step over the rubble into a new way of thinking.[6]



6.1 Early thirteenth-century Arabic